archaic animist myth, according to which snakes are not our enemies, but our ancestors.[9] Many animist cultures believed that humans descended from animals, including from snakes and other reptiles. Most Australian Aborigines believed that the Rainbow Serpent created the world. The Aranda and Dieri people maintained that their particular tribes originated from primordial lizards or snakes, which were transformed into humans.[10] In fact, modern Westerners too think that they have evolved from reptiles. The brain of each and every one of us is built around a reptilian core, and the structure of our bodies is essentially that of modified reptiles.



Credit 1.12

12. Paradise lost (the Sistine Chapel). The serpent – who sports a human upper body – initiates the entire chain of events. While the first two chapters of Genesis are dominated by divine monologues ('and God said...and God said... and God said ...'), in the third chapter we finally get a dialogue – between Eve and the serpent ('and the serpent said unto the woman...and the woman said unto the serpent ...'). This unique conversation between a human and an animal leads to the fall of humanity and our expulsion from Eden.

The authors of the book of Genesis may have preserved a remnant of archaic animist beliefs in Eve's name, but they took great care to conceal all other traces. Genesis says that, instead of